

Settlement & Urbanisation - Why Here?

I can explain settlement growth through a connected causal chain, weigh a counter-factor and reach a qualified judgement.

[Open the original interactive lesson](#)

Arrival · retrieve and reconnect

Standard

Retrieve the W9 pattern and offer one possible explanation labelled as a hypothesis.

Starter · enquiry / tension

Enquiry

Why do settlements grow, and who experiences the effects differently?

QUESTION / HYPOTHESIS

From 25 people to 91,000 in a century. Why here, and why then?

MAP / DATA / METHOD

A causal chain joins events with so . Each link needs evidence.

PATTERN + ANOMALY

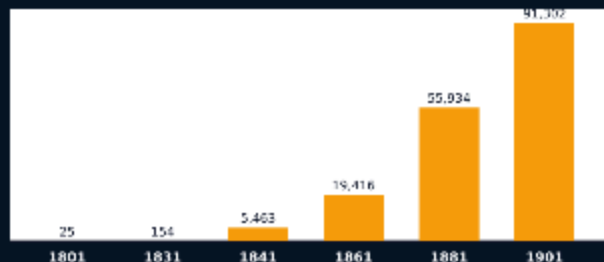
Counter-factor: Stockton had the river first. Why did it not grow as fast?

Starter · enquiry / tension

JUDGEMENT + LIMIT

Weigh the factors. Then say which mattered most — and what the evidence cannot settle.

Starter · enquiry / tension



Middlesbrough population, census years (rounded to published census totals)



Causal chain: railway then ironstone



Full causal chain to 1901

Bar chart of Middlesbrough population growth 1801 to 1901

Starter · enquiry / tension

“The railway caused Middlesbrough.”

Too strong. The railway made a port possible;
ironstone, capital and migrant workers turned a port into a town.

a qualified judgement names the strongest factor AND its limit

A qualified judgement

I Do · model geographical reasoning

Model one reasoning step at a time.

Settlement growth is change in one settlement; urbanisation is a rising share of people living in urban areas.

Build Driver → Process → Spatial change → Impact, rather than listing disconnected causes.

Use jobs, transport, housing, services and migration as interacting factors, not a single automatic cause.

Causal chain builder · choose the links in order, then weigh them

I Do · model geographical reasoning

Dates: railway extension 1830 · ironstone found in the Eston Hills 1850 · census totals 1841 5,463 → 1861 19,416 → 1901 91,302. Check against the source pack before quoting.

A. Ironworks open; workers arrive from Wales, Ireland, Scotland and the countryside

B. 1830: the railway is extended to a new coal port on the Tees

C. 1901: population passes 90,000

D. 1850: ironstone is found in the Eston Hills, close to the port

I Do · model geographical reasoning

Chain: —

Weigh a counter-factor

- A. Stockton had the river first — so the river alone cannot explain it
- B. The coal port was slow at first — so the railway alone cannot explain it
- C. The town needed people to choose to move — so growth also depended on migrants

Each counter-factor limits one claim. Choose to see which.

I Do · model geographical reasoning

A. Judgement: the railway caused the town

B. Judgement: ironstone was decisive, but only because the railway and port already existed

Which judgement is qualified?

We Do · hinge judgement

Commit before reveal: Which evidence most directly demonstrates urbanisation?

- A. One town's population rises.
- B. New homes are built beside a road.
- C. The fictional region's urban population share rises from 54% to 67%.

I Do 2 · counter / qualification

Strengthen—not lengthen—the reasoning.

Consequences are uneven: identify who gains, who bears a cost and at what scale.

Rank the strongest factor, then test it with a counter-factor or counterfactual.

Urban growth is not automatically positive or negative; a judgement must expose the trade-off.

We Do 2 · interactive reasoning lab

Urban Futures Board

CONSTRUCTED CLASSROOM RESOURCE: This fictional composite is inspired by the broad Teesside setting. It is not official data, is not to scale and must not be used for navigation, safety or real-world planning.

Spend up to three planning tokens. Gauges are bounded 0–10 classroom indices, not official forecasts. There is no perfect score: defend the trade-off with evidence.

We Do 2 · interactive reasoning lab

- A. Brownfield homes
- B. ↗ Edge expansion
- C. Bus investment
- D. Riverside green
- E. ↶ Reset



Choose a policy. Then explain one gain, one cost and who experiences each.

Independent · sustained evidence

Independent mission

I can explain settlement growth through a connected causal chain, weigh a counter-factor and reach a qualified judgement.

16 minutes. Approved access can change format, reading load or response mode; it cannot supply the geographical judgement.

Supported

Arrange the causal cards, add one time-series figure and explain one chain with because → therefore → however.

Independent · sustained evidence

Supported access: causal-chain tiles and stakeholder icons; learner supplies the link.

Standard

Use two quantified changes in a connected causal chain, then weigh a counter-factor or stakeholder trade-off.

Standard scaffold: driver → process → evidence → impact → however.

Stretch

Independent · sustained evidence

Make a planning decision using two time-series figures, defend it from two stakeholder viewpoints and weigh a counter-policy.

Stretch scaffold: ranked factor → counter-factor/counterfactual → qualified verdict.

Exit · evidence → response → Influence

VOICE: Complete: Urbanisation is more than population growth because... Then state the strongest evidence limit.